

Silhouette (Clustering)

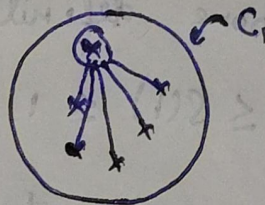
M-41

1. For each data point $i \in C_1$ (data point i is in the cluster C_1), let

$$a(i) = \frac{1}{|C_1| - 1} \sum_{j \in C_1, i \neq j} d(i, j)$$

be the mean distance between i and all other data points in the same cluster, where $|C_1|$ is the number of points belonging to cluster C_1 , and $d(i, j)$ is the distance between data points i and j in the cluster C_1 (we divide by $|C_1| - 1$ because we do not include the distance $d(i, i)$ in the sum). We can interpret $a(i)$ as a measure of how well i is assigned to its cluster (the smaller the value, the better the assignment).

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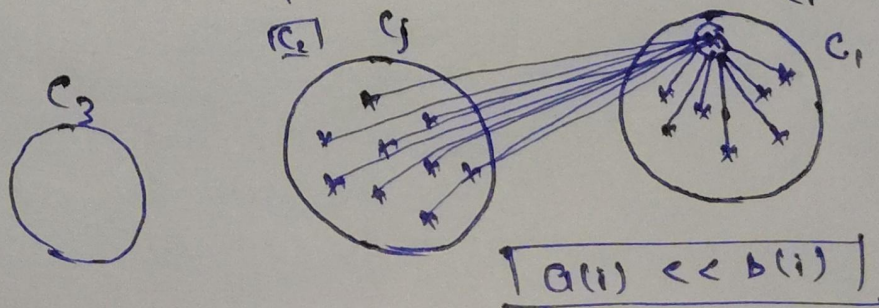


2. We then define the mean dissimilarity of point i to some cluster C_j as the mean of the distance from i to all points in C_j (where $C_j \neq C_i$).

For each data point $i \in C_1$, we now define

$$b(i) = \min_{j \neq 1} \frac{1}{|C_j|} \sum_{j \in C_j} d(i, j)$$

to be the smallest (hence the min operator in the formula) mean distance of i to all points in any other cluster, of which i is not a member. The cluster with this smallest mean dissimilarity is said to be the "neighboring cluster" of i because it is the next best fit cluster for point i .



iii. Silhouette Score

we now define a silhouette (value) of one data point i :

$$S(i) = \frac{b(i) - a(i)}{\max\{a(i), b(i)\}}, \text{ if } |C_i| > 1$$

and

$$S(i) = 0, \text{ if } |C_i| = 1$$

which can be also written as:

$$S(i) = \begin{cases} 1 - a(i)/b(i) & \text{if } a(i) < b(i) \\ 0 & \text{if } a(i) = b(i) \\ (b(i)/a(i) - 1) & \text{if } a(i) > b(i) \end{cases}$$

from the above definition it is clear that

$$-1 \leq S(i) \leq 1$$

-1 to 1 more near to 1 better clustering model we have created.

